

SPORTS HOTLINE

By MICKEY HERSKOWITZ
and STEVE PERKINS

Q. I have read that Bobby Knight may leave Indiana for a fat contract with a pro team "on the West Coast." Which team and what's the deal?—Tom Abruzzi, Philadelphia.

A. It can't be Golden State, where Al Attles clearly has done the best coaching job in the NBA. It isn't Los Angeles, where owner Jack Kent Cooke will give Bill Sharman one more year to win with Abdul-Jabbar. So that leaves Portland, where Bill Walton keeps breaking things, and the fans are disillusioned, and Lenny Wilkens has a last-place team on his hands.

Portland is believed ready to offer Knight a long-term contract at a salary of over \$100,000 a year, which would put him in a bracket with Bill Russell as the highest paid coaches in pro basketball. It also would put him right up there with some of his own players, the ones who aren't starting. By the time this season is over, Knight may have yet another offer: from Chicago, where the volatile Dick Motta is on the verge of splitting.

HOTLINE FEEDBACK—"To set the record straight, in 1926 I was a rookie up from the Texas League (with the New York Giants) when Travis Jackson injured his leg. I filled in a few games that year, 19 or 20, and batted only .259. However, in 1926 Frank Frisch was the regular second sacker and got traded in '27 for Rogers Hornsby, who was traded later that season to the Boston Braves for Shorty Hogan and Jimmy Welsh.

"So in 1928 I became the regular second baseman, batting .274. Hornsby hit .387. He not only beat me but led the entire league. The next year (1929) I hit .294. While by today's standards that is considered respectable, I eventually was sent down to Newark for Doc Pruitt, a lefthanded screwball pitcher. Later, I managed all over the minors, including Denver and New Orleans. My last job in the pros was in Philadelphia as a coach in 1960. I am now the baseball coach at Texas El Paso. I might have been a disappointment to some people, but not to myself. I am proud of my career as a player, manager, coach and scout."—Andy Cohen, El Paso.

(Do you have a question about a sports